BONNEY WATSON

Cremation or Burial

The two set side by side, honestly, and where cremated remains can go afterward.

Almost everything

That is how much of a funeral stays the same either way. Cremation is a method of preparation, not a smaller service. **A viewing, a full service, military honors, a place at the cemetery, a marker with a name on it, resting beside your spouse**: every one of those is still yours if you choose cremation.

WHAT ACTUALLY DIFFERS

	Burial	Cremation
Viewing and service	**Available**	**Available**, with a rented casket if you wish
Timing	Usually within a few weeks	No deadline at all. Whenever the family chooses
Cemetery property	A burial space is required	Optional. This is the single largest difference in cost
Container	A casket, and an outer burial container	A cremation container, then an urn. An urn vault if buried
Where they can rest	A grave, a lawn crypt, or a mausoleum	Six options, shown below
Can it be divided	No	Yes. Keepsakes and jewelry let several people hold something
Is it reversible	A grave can be disinterred, with permission and cost	No. Cremation cannot be undone

THE COST DIFFERENCE, HONESTLY

Cremation usually costs less for one reason: **placement is not required**. A burial needs a space, a container, an opening and closing, and a marker. A cremation needs none of those unless you want them. Choose them anyway and the two land close together, which surprises most families. I will price both on paper so you are comparing real numbers. We own and operate our own crematory on site and do our own transfers, and we have been family owned since 1868.

WHERE CREMATED REMAINS CAN GO

Six places they can go, not one.

Families take the urn home because nobody told them there was anything else.



A columbarium niche



Buried in an urn garden



A mausoleum crypt



A post or bench on the path

A columbarium niche
A compartment in a wall, granite front or glass front. Six settings across the park.

A mausoleum crypt
Above-ground entombment, for families who would rather not be in the ground.

Buried in an urn garden
Ground burial of the urn, marked the same way any grave would be.

A scattering garden
Scattered here, with a memorial so there is still a name and a place to come back to.

Added to a family space
Placed with a spouse or parent already here. An urn can share a space with a casket.

Kept at home
A real choice, and a common one. Say out loud who takes the urn next, and tell them.

Remains can also be divided, so a portion rests here and a portion is scattered somewhere that mattered. You are not choosing only one of these.

WHY A PLACE MATTERS

A resting place is not for the person who has died. **It is findable**, so a grandchild not yet born can stand in front of it one day. **It belongs to everyone**, where an urn in one person's home belongs to that household. **It outlasts all of us**, because the endowment care fund maintains it in perpetuity. None of that makes keeping an urn at home wrong. It is worth knowing what a permanent place adds, so that keeping the urn is something you chose rather than something that happened.

THREE THINGS FAMILIES ASK

Does our faith allow cremation?
It depends on the tradition, and the honest answer is that we are not the right people to decide it for you. Some faiths require burial, some permit cremation with conditions about how the remains are treated, and some have no view at all. Speak with your clergy. If it would help, we are glad to be part of that conversation.

Do we have to buy cemetery property if we choose cremation?
No. That is the main reason cremation usually costs less. But not being required is different from not being worth it, which is what the six settings above are there for.

We have had an urn at home for years. Is it too late?
Not at all, and you would be in good company. Families come to us with urns they have kept for ten or twenty years, often after a move or a death in the family made the question urgent. There is no time limit and nothing to explain.

No decision is needed in the room

I will lay both out and price them side by side, so you are comparing real numbers rather than impressions. There is no cost to ask and nothing attached to it. Take as long as you need afterward.

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